

SON OF THE SOIL Baghel sows seeds on the occasion of Akti Tihar and Mati Pujan Day at Agricultural University, Raipur

BHUPESH KESHARWANI

WOOING VOTERS THROUGH...

FARM SECTOR

- Farm loans waived as per 2018 poll promise
- Paying a bonus on procurement of paddy—**₹2,500** per quintal
- Maximum saleable quantity of paddy up from **15 to 20** quintals
- Those farmers who do not grow paddy get a flat **₹10,000** per acre
- Plans to procure other crops, including pulses and coarse grains

RURAL DEVELOPMENT

- Developing water sources, livestock and compost
- Promoting organic farming and small patches of land for crop cultivation
- Procuring cow dung and urine from cattle owners
- Marketing cow-based products like paints and *agarbattis* via a network
- As part of the Nyay scheme, landless labourers get **₹6,000** per annum

CASTE, CULTURE & SOFT HINDUTVA

- Wooing OBC and other castes through various initiatives and appointments of their leaders
- Promoting Chhattisgarhi identity through songs, cuisine etc.
- Developing Hindu holy sites for religious tourism
- Organising Ramayan recitation, Ramleela contests, *kathas* etc. Building Ram Van Gaman Path

are far more small farmers than big ones. Other filters like income tax payment, government employment etc. also debar farmers from being beneficiaries. The Congress government in Chhattisgarh, on the other hand, covers all farmers, the rationale based on social realities. Central Chhattisgarh, where almost 65 of the state's 90 assembly seats are located, has large land holdings. The landowners, locally called Daus, are not caste-specific and could be Brahmins, Thakurs, Banias and even from OBC communities such as Kurmis, Yadavs and Sahus. It is these Daus who have been the bigger beneficiaries of the paddy procurement payouts. The Congress strategists believe that it is these Daus who will support the party in the next election. The Daus continue to hold sway over the rural economy

ASSEMBLY PERFORMANCE

Total seats: **90**

